

JAMES MATTHEW HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 7 years of experience building scalable infrastructure and leading technical teams across fintech and enterprise software. I've spent the last three years architecting cloud-native solutions at high-growth startups and managing complex legacy system migrations. I enjoy solving infrastructure challenges and mentoring engineers to grow into senior technical roles.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the infrastructure migration of a monolithic application to Kubernetes, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and cutting infrastructure costs by 35 percent.

Established and mentored a team of 5 junior and mid-level engineers, implementing code review standards and architectural decision records that improved code quality metrics by 28 percent.

Designed and implemented a multi-region disaster recovery strategy supporting 99.99 percent uptime SLA for critical services handling over 2 million daily transactions.

Drove the adoption of Infrastructure as Code across the organisation, migrating 40 legacy manual processes to Terraform, improving deployment consistency and reducing configuration drift incidents to near zero.

Senior Software Engineer

Pinnacle Digital

pinnacle-digital.net

London, United Kingdom

August 2019 - February 2022

Architected a real-time data pipeline using Apache Kafka and Apache Spark, processing 500 million events daily with sub-second latency for a major financial services client.

Reduced database query response time from 8 seconds to 200 milliseconds through query optimisation and implementation of Redis caching across 15 microservices.

Managed the complete infrastructure for a SaaS product serving 80 enterprise customers, overseeing Docker containerisation and CI/CD pipeline optimisation that cut release cycles from weekly to daily deployments.

Collaborated with product and security teams to implement OAuth 2.0 and SAML authentication across the platform, eliminating three critical security vulnerabilities identified in external audits.

Software Engineer

Waystone Technology

waystone.co

Bristol, United Kingdom

June 2017 - July 2019

Developed and maintained backend services supporting an e-commerce platform handling 50,000 concurrent users and 10 million pounds annual transaction volume using Java Spring Boot and PostgreSQL.

Implemented automated testing framework increasing unit test coverage from 32 percent to 78 percent, reducing production defect escape rate by 42 percent.

Built monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, enabling proactive incident detection that reduced mean time to resolution by 55 percent.

Participated in on-call rotation supporting production systems, handling incidents ranging from database performance degradation to deployment issues with average resolution time of 22 minutes.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Bristol

Bristol, United Kingdom

2013 - 2017

SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Containerisation and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Programming Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, Load Balancing, VPN Configuration

Agile Methodologies: Scrum, Kanban